



SHREDDED SYSTEM

RESEARCH REPORT

Vince Gironda's diet, Mike Mentzer's training and a safe
route from 95 kg to 70–75 kg

October 2026 · Not medical advice

SUMMARY

You weigh about 95 kg and want to be visibly lean ("shredded") at 70–75 kg. This report looks at what Vince Gironda's diet actually was, which parts of it hold up against current evidence, and how to combine it with Mike Mentzer's training and Mike Dolce's habits so the plan works for 6–12 months, not 6 weeks.

The short version:

1. **Fat loss comes from the calorie deficit.** Gironda's low-carbohydrate meat-and-eggs approach works because it is high in protein, very filling and very simple, which makes a deficit easy to keep. When calories and protein are matched, low-carb and higher-carb diets lose about the same fat [3][7][8].
2. **Keep Gironda's core and fix its gaps.** Meat and eggs on most days, a planned carb-up every 72–96 hours, and nothing processed. Add 300–500 g of green vegetables a day, some berries or psyllium for fibre, and leaner cuts to bring saturated fat down. Your current two-meal strict day has 0 g of fibre and about 47 g of saturated fat [12][13].
3. **Lose 0.5–1.0% of bodyweight a week.** That is about 0.5–0.9 kg a week now, slowing to 0.35–0.7 kg near the end [1][6]. Expect 75 kg around **May–June 2027** and 70 kg around **August–September 2027** if you start on 5 October 2026, including two short diet breaks.
4. **Train briefly and hard, but not to failure on everything.** Mentzer's one-set, high-effort approach works. Current evidence says two sets usually beats one a little, and stopping 1–2 reps short of failure gives nearly the same result with less fatigue [15][16][17][18]. Two full-body sessions a week plus daily walking is enough to keep muscle while dieting.
5. **Whether 70 kg is right depends on your lean mass.** At 10–12% body fat, 70–75 kg fits a lean mass of roughly 63–67 kg. If you carry more muscle than that, you will look shredded nearer 75 kg, and pushing to 70 kg would mean losing muscle. Decide at 75 kg, not now (section 7).
6. **Retatrutide needs a clinician.** It is still an investigational drug, not approved in the UK or the US for prescription [25][26]. It strongly suppresses appetite, which makes undereating and muscle loss more likely on a diet this strict. The app records medication and symptoms but never gives doses.

1. STARTING POINT

MEASURE	VALUE
Current weight	95 kg (Trainer start: 96.8 kg on 1 Oct 2026)
Goal	70–75 kg, visibly lean
To lose	20–25 kg
Current diet	Strict Gironda: two meals inside an 18:6 window
Current training	Mentzer HIT and a 4-week cycle (Trainer app)
Daily steps target	15,000 on 5 days a week

Your current strict day, from the Trainer app's own macros:

MEAL	KCAL	PROTEIN	FAT	CARBS	FIBRE
Meal 1: 6 eggs + 3 pork patties	933	77 g	66 g	5 g	0 g
Meal 2: 6 eggs + steak	932	93 g	60 g	2 g	0 g
Day	1,865	170 g	126 g	7 g	0 g

This is a good fat-loss day in two ways: protein is high and calories are controlled. It has three problems if you run it for months:

- **Fibre is zero.** The UK recommendation is 30 g a day [12]. Long stretches without fibre commonly cause constipation and remove the benefits fibre has for gut health and cholesterol.
- **Saturated fat is about 47 g**, roughly 23% of calories. UK advice is no more than about 10% (around 20 g on this intake) [13]. Twelve eggs a day also add about 2.2 g of dietary cholesterol. Some people's LDL cholesterol rises sharply on this pattern; a blood test after 8–12 weeks will tell you if you are one of them.
- **No micronutrient variety.** No vegetables means little vitamin C, folate, potassium or magnesium.

All three can be fixed without leaving Gironda's framework (section 2.4).

2. VINCE GIRONDA'S DIET

2.1 WHO HE WAS

Vince Gironda (1917–1997) ran Vince's Gym in North Hollywood and trained bodybuilders and actors from the 1950s to the 1990s. He was known for unconventional exercises and for insisting that nutrition was most of the result, often quoted as saying bodybuilding is 85% nutrition [9][24]. His writing is a mix of sharp practical observation and pre-scientific theory, so it needs sorting.

2.2 WHAT THE DIET WAS

Accounts vary, but most describe these elements [9][11][24]:

ELEMENT	GIRONDA'S VERSION
Maximum Definition / steak and eggs	Meat (mostly beef) and eggs, very little carbohydrate, for cutting.
Carb-up	After about 72 hours, or every 4–5 days, a carbohydrate meal or day to refill glycogen and avoid going "flat".
No processed food	No sugar, flour or junk. Food as close to natural as possible.
Raw dairy and raw eggs	Certified raw milk, cream and raw eggs, especially in his high-protein mass diet (famously up to three dozen eggs a day).
Heavy supplementation	Liver tablets, kelp, wheat germ oil, digestive enzymes and more.
Simplicity	The same few meals, eaten on schedule.

2.3 WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS ABOUT EACH PART

GIRONDA ELEMENT	VERDICT	WHY
High protein, meat and eggs	Keep	Higher protein keeps more muscle in a deficit and is the most filling macronutrient [4][5][31].
Low carbohydrate on most days	Keep, but it is optional	It works by making the deficit easy, not through a special mechanism. Matched for calories and protein, low-carb and low-fat diets lose the same fat [3][7][8]. If you like it, use it.
Planned carb-ups	Keep	Planned higher-calorie days and diet breaks may help keep training quality, and in some studies lean mass, during long diets [10][11]. They also give the diet a pressure valve, so you avoid unplanned binges.
No processed food	Keep	Ultra-processed food makes overeating easier.
Same meals every day	Keep	Fewer decisions means fewer mistakes. This suits low conscientiousness well.
Meat and eggs only, no plants	Fix	Zero fibre and high saturated fat (section 1) [12][13].
Raw eggs	Drop	In the UK, British Lion eggs are considered safe raw [28], but cooked egg protein is absorbed far better: about 91% against 51% raw [27]. Raw eggs waste protein.
Raw milk and cream	Drop	Unpasteurised milk carries a real risk of food poisoning [14].
Long supplement lists	Mostly drop	Little evidence for most of them. A multivitamin, vitamin D in winter and fish oil (if you eat no oily fish) are reasonable.
36 eggs a day	Drop	That was a mass-gaining diet with over 2,500 kcal from eggs. It doesn't belong in a cut.

2.4 THE GIRONDA CUT: GIRONDA WITH THE GAPS FIXED

The recommended default day keeps meat and eggs as the base of every meal, keeps carbohydrates low on most days and keeps the carb-up. The changes are vegetables, a fibre top-up and leaner meat.

MEAL	KCAL	PROTEIN	FAT	CARBS	FIBRE
Meal 1: 4 eggs, 250 g 5% beef patties, spinach, mushrooms, 5 g butter	678	85 g	35 g	3 g	3 g
Meal 2: 250 g rump steak, 2 eggs, 250 g broccoli, salad, 15 g olive oil	690	76 g	36 g	10 g	8 g
Top-up: 200 g 0% Greek yogurt, berries, 25 g almonds, 5 g psyllium	310	27 g	15 g	15 g	9 g
Day	1,678	187 g	85 g	28 g	20 g

Compared with the strict day, protein goes up by 17 g, saturated fat roughly halves (47 g to 25 g) and fibre goes from 0 to 20 g, while carbohydrates stay under 30 g. Scale portions to your calorie target (section 5).

2.5 THE CARB-UP

Gironda's rule was a carbohydrate meal about every 72 hours. The modern version used here is one carb-up day every 72–96 hours, placed on or before a training day:

- Calories at roughly maintenance (2,200–2,500 kcal to start).
- Protein unchanged.
- Fat low (around 40–50 g).
- Carbohydrates 200–300 g from rice, potatoes, oats and fruit.
- Not a cheat day. It is planned to the gram.

The template carb-up day in the app is 2,224 kcal with 267 g of carbohydrate and 35 g of fibre.

A heavier week will follow a carb-up because glycogen holds water (roughly 3 g of water per gram of glycogen). That is not fat. Judge the trend over 7 days.

3. MIKE MENTZER'S TRAINING

3.1 THE SYSTEM

Mentzer's Heavy Duty system [20][21][22]:

- One working set per exercise, taken to positive failure and sometimes beyond (rest-pause, negatives, forced reps).
- Low total volume: often 5–9 working sets a session.
- Long recovery: sessions every 4–7 days, and longer as you get stronger.
- 6–10 reps for the upper body, 12–20 for legs and abs.
- Precise logging and progressive overload as the only measure of success.

3.2 WHAT HOLDS UP

MENTZER IDEA	VERDICT	EVIDENCE
Effort drives results	Keep	Sets need to be close to failure to be effective [17][18].
One set is enough to progress	Partly	One set works, especially for beginners. Two to three sets give somewhat more growth and strength on average [15][16].
Train to failure every set	Modify	Failure isn't required. Stopping 1–2 reps short gives similar gains with less fatigue [17][18]. In a big deficit, recovery is already limited.
Long rest between sessions	Keep, with walking	Two brief sessions a week is enough to keep muscle while dieting. Daily walking adds calorie burn without hurting recovery.
Record every session	Keep	Strength holding steady is your best sign you are keeping muscle.

3.3 RECOMMENDATION FOR THE CUT

Two full-body sessions a week (A and B, section 5 of the guide), 1–2 sets per exercise, 6–10 reps on compounds and 8–15 on isolation work, stopping 1–2 reps short of failure on compounds. Machine and isolation exercises can go to technical failure occasionally. Forced reps, uncontrolled negatives and failure on free-weight squats or hinges are left out until the cut is over.

If you prefer the Mentzer programmes already in your Trainer app, they fit this plan as they are: the diet is the priority, and training's job is to protect muscle.

4. MIKE DOLCE'S HABITS

The Dolce books in your Drive add execution habits rather than a new diet: shopping lists, cooking in batches, eating on a schedule, writing everything down and setting daily goals [23]. All of those are built into the guide and the app.

The fight-week weight-cut methods in *3 Weeks to Shredded* (dehydration, water loading, sodium manipulation) are for weigh-ins, not for fat loss. They are excluded from this plan.

5. HOW FAST TO LOSE

The NHS recommends 0.5–1 kg a week for safe weight loss [1]. For people who also want to keep muscle, 0.5–1.0% of bodyweight a week is the usual target [6], which at 95 kg is 0.5–0.95 kg a week and slows naturally as you get lighter.

Projected timeline from 5 October 2026, with the rate stepping down from 0.9% to 0.7% to 0.5% a week as you get leaner, plus two 2-week diet breaks:

MILESTONE	WEEKS	APPROXIMATE DATE
90 kg	6	mid-November 2026
85 kg	13	early January 2027
80 kg	21–23	March 2027
75 kg	32–36	May–June 2027
72.5 kg	39–43	July 2027
70 kg	46–50	August–September 2027

Going faster (1% every week) gets you to 75 kg in about 24 weeks, but muscle loss and rebound get more likely the leaner you get. The decision rules in the app slow you down if strength or energy drop.

6. CALORIES AND MACROS

6.1 CALORIES

Your maintenance calories aren't known yet: height, age and activity change them a lot. Two ways to find them:

- **Estimate:** the Mifflin-St Jeor equation [29] times an activity factor. The app does this once you enter height and age.
- **Measure (better):** log food and weight for 14 days. Maintenance = average intake + (weight lost in kg × 7,700 ÷ 14).

Start at **400–600 kcal below maintenance**. With your current routine that is likely to land around 1,800–2,100 kcal on low days. The app will not suggest less than 1,500 kcal a day (1,200 for women) without a clinician involved.

6.2 MACROS

NUTRIENT	TARGET	REASON
Protein	160 g (range 150–190 g)	1.6 g/kg is the evidence-based floor [4]; lean people in a deficit do better nearer 2.3–3.1 g/kg of lean mass [5].
Fat	60–90 g	Enough for hormones and for Gironda-style meals.
Carbohydrate	Under 50 g on low days; 200–300 g on carb-ups	Gironda structure.
Fibre	25–30 g	UK guideline [12].
Saturated fat	Under about 25 g	UK guideline: around 10% of energy [13].

7. WHAT "SHREDDED AT 70–75 KG" MEANS

Being shredded means body fat of roughly 8–12% for a man. Your target weight is your lean mass divided by $(1 - \text{target body fat})$:

LEAN MASS	AT 10% FAT	AT 12% FAT	AT 15% FAT
62 kg	68.9 kg	70.5 kg	72.9 kg
65 kg	72.2 kg	73.9 kg	76.5 kg
68 kg	75.6 kg	77.3 kg	80.0 kg

So 70 kg only makes sense if your lean mass is about 62–63 kg. Everyone loses some lean mass while dieting; resistance training and high protein keep it small. Practical approach:

1. Diet to 75 kg.
2. Judge by photos, waist and strength, or get a DEXA scan.
3. If you still have visible fat to lose and strength is holding, continue toward 70 kg. If you are already lean and strength is falling, stop and move to maintenance.

8. MEDICATION: RETATRUTIDE

Your earlier notes mention 6 mg of retatrutide. As of October 2026, retatrutide is an investigational drug made by Eli Lilly. It has strong phase 2 and phase 3 results, but it is not approved for prescription in the UK or the US [25][26]. Supplies outside a trial are unregulated: the MHRA warns that weight-loss injections bought online may be fake, contaminated or the wrong dose [30].

What it means for this plan:

- **Appetite.** It strongly reduces hunger. With a strict diet on top, undereating is easy, and very low intakes with low protein speed up muscle loss. Hit the protein target every day even when you aren't hungry.
- **Side effects.** In the trial, gastrointestinal effects (nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, constipation) were common and dose-related, and heart rate rose [25]. Drugs in the same family carry warnings for pancreatitis and gallbladder disease. Large, very fatty meals slow digestion further and may make nausea worse.
- **Fasting.** Extended fasts (over 24 hours) on top of an appetite-suppressing drug aren't advised without a clinician.

The app has a medication and symptom log, red-flag warnings (severe abdominal pain, repeated vomiting and others) and nothing else. It never suggests doses, schedules or sources. Please review this with a GP or another prescriber.

9. SAFETY RULES BUILT INTO THE PLAN

- No dehydration, water loading, sodium manipulation, diuretics or laxatives.
- No raw eggs, raw meat or unpasteurised dairy.
- Calories never below 1,500 kcal/day (men) or 1,200 kcal/day (women) without clinical supervision.
- Protein never below 140 g/day.
- A 1–2 week diet break at maintenance every 8–12 weeks.
- Stop and seek help for red-flag symptoms (listed in the guide and the app).
- A blood test (lipids, liver, kidney, glucose) at the start and after about 12 weeks is sensible on a high-fat, high-protein diet, and essential if you take retatrutide.

10. LIMITS OF THIS REPORT

- Gironda's methods come from his books, interviews and later accounts, not controlled trials. The historical details are summarised from secondary sources [9][11][24].
- Calorie and macro figures for foods are typical UK values; brands differ. The pork patty values are back-calculated from your Trainer macros.
- The timeline is a projection. Your real rate will be set by the 14-day decision rules.
- This is not medical advice. Your medication in particular needs a clinician.

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